dīn returned to Balkh. However, he was not admitted into the city because the people of Balkh feared retaliation for their support of the Aūzbeg. This fear might indicate that he had brought a significant reinforcement to Babur. Khwāja Kamālu'd-dīn then continued into Khurāsān, where he was killed. The recapture of Balkh for the Shāh by Deo Sulṭān was a reversal of Aūzbeg control in the region, and this development helps explain how Babur came to be in Balkh in AD 1517.

26 February of AD 1514 to 15 February of AD 1515

Haidar's writings depict Babur as if he were in Qūndūz[‡] during this year. According to Haidar, Babur endured significant hardship and want, but he bore it with his characteristic courtesy and patience. Eventually, he gave up hope of successfully recovering Ḥiṣār and returned to Kābul. It appears that he made the stay in Khwāst, as referred to later,[*] during which his daughter Gul-rang was born, as corroborated by Gul-badan's chronicle.

At the end of the year, after enduring the hardships of winter, Babur reached Kābul. When he had retaken Samarkand in AD 1511, he had entrusted Kābul to his half-brother Nāṣir Mīrzā. Nāṣir Mīrzā warmly welcomed Babur and professed his devotion and respect. He spoke of guarding Kābul on Babur's behalf and requested permission to return to his former fief, Ghaznī. Nāṣir Mīrzā's conduct deeply affected Babur, and it would have been perceived as a humane gesture during a time of disappointment and failure.

15 February of AD 1515 to 5 February of AD 1516

Rebellion of chiefs in Ghaznī

Shortly after his return to Ghaznī, Nāṣir Mīrzā passed away. Following his death, disputes erupted among various commanders in Ghaznī. Sherīm ṭaghāī was one of the key figures involved, and the main source of the turmoil was the Moghūls. However, many others were also caught up in the conflict, including long-serving individuals like Bābā of Pashāghar.[†] [‡]

Haidar did not have precise information about the exact cause of the dispute or why it had turned against Babur. He attributed the conflict to Satan taking hold of the chiefs' minds, resulting in an increase in vanity and wickedness. It's possible that the dispute revolved around the question of succession after Nāṣir's death. During the ensuing battle, Dost Beg distinguished himself, and Qaṃbar-i-'alī, the son of Qāsim